Eunsun Kim

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Education

University of California, Los Angeles, Ph.D. in Quantitative Marketing — Expected 2027

Duke University, M.S. in Economics and Computation — 2021

Seoul National University, M.S. in Quantitative Marketing — 2019

Seoul National University, B.A. in Business — 2017
summa cum laude; Minor in Economics

Research Interest

Quantitative Marketing, Empirical Industrial Organization, Algorithmic Pricing

Job Market Paper

Dominant Followership in AI-Driven Algorithmic Pricing

Abstract: Pricing algorithms allow firms to monitor and respond to rival price changes at scale. This paper studies how such responsiveness affects competition when firms differ in demand-side market power. Using high-frequency cross-platform pricing data, I identify sequential price adjustments and measure firms' responses to rivals' earlier price changes. Amazon's behavior is distinct: rival changes predict its later adjustments, especially same-direction responses after rival increases. To investigate how this pattern affects prices, I develop a model of dominant followership. I find that a demand-advantaged follower may match rather than undercut rival price increases to monetize its existing customer base. This mechanism raises prices only when the demand-advantaged firm moves second. In Q-learning simulations, the same timing condition determines long-run outcomes: after observing rival price changes, the demand-advantaged firm learns response rules that sustain higher prices and reproduce Amazon's tendency to follow rival increases without pricing above them.

Working Papers

Consumer-Side AI Shopping Agents and Algorithmic Pricing

Abstract: This project studies how consumer-side AI shopping agents change competition when firms use pricing algorithms. The key feature is that agents can observe cross-platform price histories: they track relative prices across platforms and price changes over time, then choose where and when to buy. I compare demand environments that differ in the purchase rule delegated to the agent: buying from the default firm, searching across platforms before buying, or delaying purchase until a lower cross-platform price is available. The analysis asks whether access to these histories erodes dominant platforms' demand advantages by lowering search frictions and shifting consumers toward cheaper rivals, or whether default position and loyalty allow those advantages to persist.

Honors and Research Grants

AMA-Sheth Consortium Fellow	2026
NBER Digital Economics and AI Tutorial	2025
Haring Symposium Fellow	2025
ISMS Doctoral Consortium Fellow	2023, 2025
Price Center for Entrepreneurship and Innovation Research Grant	2024
Grand Prize, Mock Fair Trade Commission Contest, Korea Fair Trade Commission	2017
Dean's List, Seoul National University Business School	2015, 2016

Presentations

Dominant Followership in AI-Driven Algorithmic Pricing

Industrial Organization Proseminar, Department of Economics, UCLA	2025, 2026
World Congress of the Econometric Society (ESWC)	2025
ISMS Marketing Science Conference	2025
Artificial Intelligence in Management (AIM) Conference	2025

Discussions

Haring Symposium	2025
California Quantitative Marketing Ph.D. Student Conference	2023, 2024

Teaching Experience	Teaching Assistant, UCLA Anderson School of Management Customer Assessment and Analytics Statistical Foundations for Data Analytics Data and Decisions	2022–present
	Teaching Assistant, Duke University Everything Data (Computer Science) Linear Algebra (Mathematics) Calculus (Mathematics)	2019–2021
	Teaching Assistant, Seoul National University Business School Data-Driven Marketing Analytics Marketing Management	2018–2019
Past Employment	Mobile Market Research, LG Display	2017
	Internship, Barun Law LLC	2015
Programming	Python, R, MATLAB, C++, LaTeX	

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